

FIFA World Cup 2026

USA • Canada • Mexico

The 23rd FIFA World Cup — June 11 to July 19, 2026

Edition	23rd FIFA World Cup
Dates	Thursday, June 11 – Sunday, July 19, 2026 (39 days)
Hosts	United States (11 cities), Mexico (3), Canada (2)
Host cities / venues	16 cities, 16 stadiums
Teams	48 (expanded from 32) across 6 confederations
Matches	104 total (72 group stage + 32 knockout)
Format	12 groups of 4; knockout begins at Round of 32
Opening match	Mexico vs South Africa — Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
Final	MetLife Stadium, New Jersey
Defending champions	Argentina (2022)

A Tournament of Firsts

The 2026 edition is the largest World Cup ever staged and the first to be co-hosted by three nations. It is also the first to feature 48 teams, up from 32, which lengthens the tournament to 39 days and raises the match count to 104. North America last hosted in 1994, when the United States staged the tournament alone. The competition stretches geographically from Vancouver on the Pacific coast to Boston in the northeast and Guadalajara in central Mexico.

Estadio Azteca in Mexico City makes history of its own: by hosting the opening match it becomes the first stadium ever to feature in three different men's World Cups (1970, 1986 and 2026). The final at MetLife Stadium will include a half-time show, a Super Bowl–inspired addition to the showpiece occasion.

Competition Format

The 48 teams are divided into 12 groups of four. Each side plays three group-stage matches. The top two from every group advance, joined by the eight best third-placed teams — producing a 32-team knockout bracket. The knockout rounds then run through the Round of 32, Round of 16, quarter-finals, semi-finals, a third-place play-off and the final.

Stage	Matches	Notes
Group stage	72	12 groups of 4; each team plays 3 games
Round of 32	16	Top 2 per group + 8 best third-placed sides

Round of 16	8	Knockout
Quarter-finals	4	Knockout
Semi-finals	2	Dallas (Jul 14) & Atlanta
Third-place play-off	1	Miami, July 18
Final	1	MetLife Stadium, July 19

Host Cities & Stadiums

Sixteen stadiums across three countries will stage the 104 matches. The United States hosts the majority, including every match from the quarter-finals onward. Capacities below are approximate tournament configurations and may differ slightly from regular-season figures.

Stadium (FIFA name)	City	Country	Approx. capacity
MetLife Stadium	New York / New Jersey	USA	82,500
AT&T Stadium	Dallas (Arlington)	USA	92,967
SoFi Stadium	Los Angeles	USA	70,000
Levi's Stadium	San Francisco Bay Area	USA	70,900
Hard Rock Stadium	Miami	USA	65,300
Mercedes-Benz Stadium	Atlanta	USA	71,000
Lumen Field	Seattle	USA	69,000
NRG Stadium	Houston	USA	72,000
Gillette Stadium	Boston (Foxborough)	USA	65,800
Lincoln Financial Field	Philadelphia	USA	69,300
Arrowhead Stadium	Kansas City	USA	76,400
Estadio Azteca	Mexico City	Mexico	~87,500
Estadio Akron	Guadalajara	Mexico	48,000
Estadio BBVA	Monterrey	Mexico	53,500
BMO Field	Toronto	Canada	45,700
BC Place	Vancouver	Canada	54,500

AT&T Stadium is the largest venue and hosts the most matches (nine, including a semi-final), while BMO Field in Toronto is the smallest. Toronto and Vancouver are hosting World Cup football for the first time.

Key Dates

Event	Date	Venue
Opening match (Mexico vs South Africa)	June 11	Estadio Azteca, Mexico City
Group stage	June 11 – 27	All host cities
Round of 32	from June 28	Various
Round of 16	early July	Various
Quarter-finals	July 9 – 11	USA venues
Semi-finals	July 14 & 15	Dallas & Atlanta
Third-place play-off	July 18	Hard Rock Stadium, Miami
Final	July 19	MetLife Stadium, New Jersey

Some knockout dates are approximate pending the final schedule confirmation. Compiled June 2026.